

Check AI Visibility Tool Data Against Your Own First-Party Data

Objective

A side-by-side sheet: what your paid AI-visibility tool says about a brand, next to what the brand's own first-party reports say for the same period. Where they agree, act. Where they don't, label the number as modelled and hold the recommendation until your own data backs it.

"I take them with a pinch of salt, especially because I compare the data." - Laura Iancu, Searchpedia

Key Steps

1. **Snapshot what the paid tool says, and date it.** Export the brand's AI-visibility numbers (Laura used Ahrefs Brand Radar) and save the file with the date in the name.
2. **Pull the first-party side for the same period.** Google Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools and Microsoft Clarity: whatever AI-surface reporting each shows, plus AI-assistant referrals in Clarity or GA4.
3. **Script the pulls instead of buying another extension.** Ask an AI assistant to write the export script. You don't need to learn Python.
4. **Line the two up topic by topic.** Same sheet, same date range. Mark each row agree, disagree or no first-party data.
5. **Check the answer engines yourself.** Run the brand's key questions in anonymous sessions of ChatGPT, Perplexity and Claude.
6. **Test before you advise.** "Let me get back to you in a month. I need the time to test it myself."
7. **Report the gap out loud.** Label tool numbers as modelled, and say where they disagree with the first-party data.
8. **Re-run the comparison each quarter.** Keep every dated snapshot; the old ones are what make the comparison possible.

Cautionary Notes

- **Synthetic is not measured.** Laura found it "very different" from platform data.
- **The samples are small.** Nobody is rushing to test on really big websites.
- **Quick wins crash.** Easy-to-abuse tactics get penalised.
- **Don't price small clients into big-tool data.** Free first-party reports come first.
- **Direct traffic is not all people.** Check for bots in Clarity before you count it.

Tips for Efficiency

- Load Clarity through Google Tag Manager on every client.
- Connect GTM and GA4 to Claude Code; ask for a GA3-style view and compare Clarity against GA4.
- Name exports *brand_tool_YYYY-MM-DD*.
- Follow practitioners who publish tested work, then test it on your own client.

Source: Laura Iancu, Searchpedia (searchpedia.co.uk), on Unscripted SEO (recorded Sept 28, 2026). Steps 5 and the Clarity/Claude tips are Jeremy Rivera's additions from the same conversation.

Full SOP: seoarcade.com/seo-sop-check-ai-visibility-data-against-first-party-data/ · Interview recap: seoarcade.com/ai-search-quick-wins-laura-iancu/